

SYLLABUS ITEM 18, PRINTED VERBATIM: "Mīmāṃsā: Theory of Knowledge."

normalised: Mīmāṃsā (Pūrva-Mīmāṃsā) · theory of knowledge = pramāṇa-vada in service of dharma

CONTROLLING QUESTION how can a human being know what he OUGHT to do, when what he ought to do cannot be seen, touched, or inferred from anything visible?

+--- THE DEFINING FORMULA -----+
| dharma-jijñāsā the school IS an inquiry into duty |
| codanā-lakṣaṇo'rtho dharmah duty is that good whose DISTINGUISHING MARK is |
| consequence Vedic injunction (codanā) |
| epistemology is INSEPARABLE from hermeneutics |
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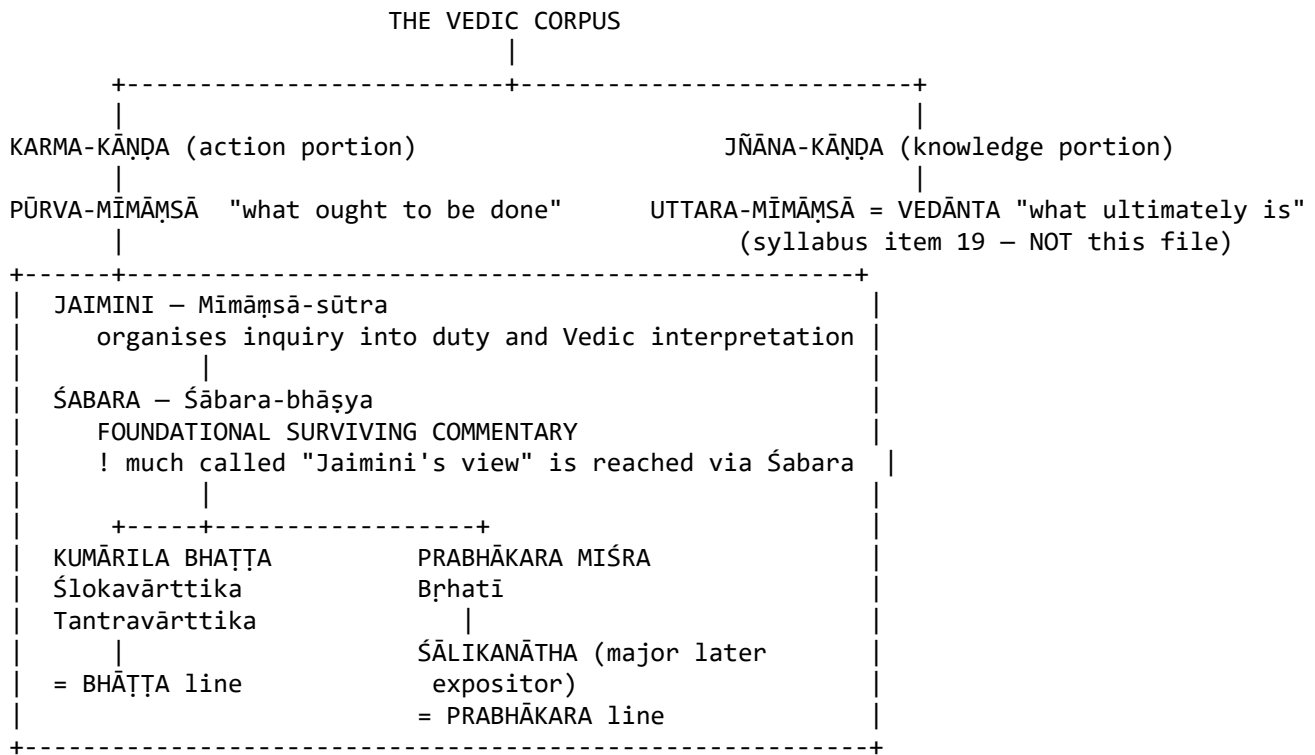
WHY EACH FAMOUS DOCTRINE EXISTS (read downwards: each repairs a specific hole)
duty is supersensible perception disqualified; inference has no sign
only verbal testimony reaches it . śabda is NOT a fallback here; it is the sole witness
but WHOSE word? a person may err, deceive, be partial, forget
=> AUTHORLESSNESS (apauruṣeyatva) removes the locus
but why trust ANY cognition? external certification regresses
=> INTRINSIC VALIDITY (svataḥ-prāmāṇya)
a text that binds with NO commander => injunction (vidhi) + bhāvanā / niyoga
an act that pays with NO paymaster => unseen ritual potency (apūrva)
therefore NO CREATOR GOD IS NEEDED ANYWHERE IN THE CHAIN (nirīśvaravāda)

MINIMUM METAPHYSICS (sparse, but load-bearing)
real enduring objects · plurality of selves as knower-agent-enjoyer
moral order regulated by action + apūrva · beginningless karmic series
THREE ENABLERS: objects real => knowledge possible · injunction meaningful =>
obligation possible · action leaves potency => future fruit possible

+--- ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE -----+
| Mīmāṃsā's theory of knowledge is not an epistemology that happens to defend a |
| scripture; it is a scripture-defence that HAD to become a general epistemology, |
| because a text with no author can borrow no authority from outside cognition. |
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! TRAP 1: do not write "Mīmāṃsā is only ritualism". The orientation is ritual; the epistemology is general.

! TRAP 2: do not treat verbal testimony as an emergency source. For duty it is the ONLY competent instrument.



OWNERSHIP FIREWALL – held HERE, not by Vedānta
 injunction · duty · authorless verbal authority · ritual interpretation
 OWNED THERE, not here
 Brahman · maya · superimposition · identity-sentences as finally disclosive

SOURCE CONTROL

- ? relative chronology of Kumāṛila and Prabhākara, and the internal layering of the commentaries, are GENUINELY DISPUTED in scholarship
- = assert DOCTRINAL OWNERSHIP confidently; assert HISTORICAL SEQUENCE cautiously

ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE
Pūrva- and Uttara-Mīmāṃsā are not two levels of one doctrine but two answers to the question of what a scripture is FOR: the earlier reads the Veda as a command, the later as a disclosure.

! TRAP 1: BHĀṬṬA (school of Kumārila Bhaṭṭa) is NOT Jayarāśi Bhaṭṭa, the sceptical Cārvāka-adjacent author.
! TRAP 2: never write "the Mīmāṃsā view" on error, absence or semantics without naming a sub-school; on all three there is no single Mīmāṃsā view.

SHARED COMMITMENTS (never broken by either sub-school)

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Vedic authority · realism about objects and selves · ritual efficacy through apūrva
intrinsic validity of cognition · IRREDUCIBILITY as the admission test for instruments

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	BHĀṬṬA (Kumārila): ADMIT what resists reduction; pay the ontological cost	PRABHĀKARA: ECONOMISE, avoid positing extra faculties
1 INSTRUMENTS	SIX	FIVE
2 ABSENCE	abhāva is REAL, with a counterpositive (pratiyogin); known by anupalabdhi	the LOCUS is perceived as bare and unqualified; no separate instrument is needed
3 ERROR	viparīta-khyāti: a REAL false cognition, caused by defect	akhyāti / vivekākhyāti: failure to DISCRIMINATE two valid cognitions; NO false cognition at all
4 COGNITION OF COGNITION	NOT self-luminous; inferred from the object's jñātātā	IS self-luminous; knower, known and knowing revealed together
5 SEMANTICS	abhihitānvayavāda: words denote first, then meanings connect	anvitābhidhānavāda: words denote only AS ALREADY CONNECTED
6 MOTIVATION	bhāvanā-vāda: the desired fruit moves the qualified agent	niyoga-vāda: the COMMAND ITSELF binds – duty for duty's sake

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EXAMINATION WEIGHT: of the 14 primary-owned parts, SIX name Bhāṭṭa or Prabhākara
explicitly, and several more are unanswerable without the distinction.

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| ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE |

| The Bhāṭṭa-Prabhākara dispute is not six quarrels but one: whether a philosopher |

| should enlarge his inventory to fit the phenomenon or trim the phenomenon to fit his |

| inventory. |

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! TRAP 1: PRABHĀKARA ACCEPTS FIVE, NOT SIX. The single most repeated error in this topic.

! TRAP 2: threefold awareness is Prabhākara's and knownness is Bhāṭṭa's – never reversed.

! TRAP 3: leanness is not superiority; Kumārila's reply is that economy purchased by
distorting the phenomenon is false economy.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/24: Intrinsic validity – the four cells and the argument

A THEORY OF VALIDITY MUST ANSWER FOUR QUESTIONS, NOT ONE

	ORIGIN (utpatti) "what MAKES it so?"	ASCERTAINMENT (jnapti) "how is it KNOWN to be so?"
VALIDITY (prāmāṇya)	MĪMĀṂSĀ: INTRINSIC the same conditions that generate the cognition generate its validity	MĪMĀṂSĀ: INTRINSIC cognition presents itself as trustworthy, unaided
INVALIDITY (aprāmāṇya)	MĪMĀṂSĀ: EXTRINSIC requires a DEFECT (doṣa): bad light, distance, organ- damage, dream-state	MĪMĀṂSĀ: EXTRINSIC requires a DEFEATER (bādhaka): contradiction, failure, correction

THE STATEMENT: every cognition carries PRIMA FACIE validity unless and until defeated.

THE ARGUMENT (eleven steps as the school gives them)

- 1 cognition is meant to disclose an object
- 2 if every cognition needed another to validate it, the validator needs validation
- 3 => ANAVASTHĀ (infinite regress)
- 4 to avoid regress, SOME cognition must be valid without external validation
- 5 most economically, EACH cognition is prima facie valid on its own
- 6 we in fact live by trusting cognitions unless a defeating condition appears
- 7 practical life confirms DEFAULT TRUST, not default doubt
- 8 hence validity is intrinsic and invalidity adventitious
- 9 if confirmation were required for every cognition, no FIRST ACTION could be launched
- 10 therefore epistemic economy favours intrinsic validity
- 11 the BURDEN OF PROOF lies on the challenger, not on every fresh cognition

PRESUPPOSITION: REALISM – cognitions are aimed at real objects and normal causes tend toward truth. Without it the doctrine collapses into subjectivist self-certification.

WORKED EXAMPLE: I see a pot; I do not suspend judgement pending a certificate; I walk round it, lift it, refer to it. Only poor light, hallucination or contradiction revokes it.

OBJECTION -> REPLY BANK

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|--------------------------------------|--|
| ! error should be impossible | -> error needs an EXTRINSIC DEFECT |
| ! this licenses gullibility | -> the thesis is DEFEASIBLE and welcomes correction |
| ! correction proves prior invalidity | -> it proves an unnoticed defect was operating |
| ! why call it valid before checking? | -> checking must itself begin from a trusted cognition |

ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE
Intrinsic validity is Mīmāṃsā's refusal to let scepticism set the terms: doubt is parasitic on a trust that must already be in place before any doubt can be raised.

! TRAP: "intrinsic validity" is DEFEASIBLE DEFAULT WARRANT, never INFALLIBILISM.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/24: The extrinsic rival and the decisive distinction

NYĀYA: PARATAH-PRAMANYAVADA – validity extrinsic in ORIGIN and in ASCERTAINMENT

ROUTE 1 successful practical activity (pravṛtti-sāmarthya)

"I walked over, touched it, drank it – so it was water"

ROUTE 2 confirming later perception (saṃvādi-pratyakṣa)

"a later perception agrees with the earlier one – so the earlier was valid"

MĪMĀṢĀ'S SEVEN-STEP CRITICISM

- 1 if action-success is needed before validity is granted, one must act BEFORE being entitled to trust the cognition
- 2 but that action ITSELF presupposes some trust already
- 3 so Nyāya secretly relies on what it officially postpones
- 4 if a later cognition validates the earlier, a further cognition must validate IT
- 5 the regress returns
- 6 therefore later success can at most CONFIRM or DISCLOSE validity, not GENERATE it
- 7 => VALIDITY ITSELF is distinguished from our reflective ASCERTAINMENT of it

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| THE DECISIVE DISTINCTION                                     |
| if validity and the ascertainment of validity are the SAME thing, Nyāya wins; |
| if they COME APART, Mīmāṃsā wins. Write that sentence and the paragraph writes itself. |
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NYĀYA'S BEST SHOT – THE DREAM / MIRAGE OBJECTION

- ! dreams and mirages arise spontaneously, FEEL entirely normal, and are FALSE
- ! if normal-looking cognitions can be false, why privilege intrinsic validity?

MĪMĀṢĀ'S REPLY – "APPEARANCE OF NORMALCY IS NOT NORMALCY"

- dream -> extrinsic defect: exhaustion, sleep-state, internal disturbance
- mirage -> extrinsic defect: heated air, optical distortion
- => these do NOT arise from fully normal truth-producing conditions; they are ABNORMAL
- => the principle stands: cognition under GENUINELY normal conditions is valid

DEFAULT TRUST AS THE STRUCTURE OF EMBODIED LIFE

- crossing a road · reading a page · recognising a friend · obeying an instruction
- all presuppose IMMEDIATE trust => the practical inevitability becomes an epistemic principle: DOUBT IS PARASITIC UPON A MORE BASIC TRUST.

DISTINCTIONS THE EXAMINER IS CHECKING

- validity is not certainty · intrinsic validity is not incorrigibility
- extrinsic invalidity does not mean error is impossible
- later confirmation is not the SOURCE of truth but one way of DETECTING correction

! RESIDUAL PRESSURE (state it in a critical answer): Nyāya can press that "abnormal conditions" is a label applied AFTER a cognition turns out false, so the line between warranted default trust and credulity is drawn by stipulation.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/24: The comparative strip – four schools on validity

SCHOOL	VALIDITY	INVALIDITY	RELATION TO MĪMĀṢĀ
MĪMĀṢĀ	INTRINSIC	EXTRINSIC	the position itself
NYĀYA	EXTRINSIC (pravṛtti-sāmarthya, saṃvādi-pratyakṣa)	EXTRINSIC	the CHIEF RIVAL on the largest epistemic contrast
SĀṂKHYA	INTRINSIC	INTRINSIC truth AND falsity both disclosed from within	ALLY that goes too far: falsity does NOT self-announce
BUDDHIST EPISTEMOLOGY	EXTRINSIC tied to causal efficacy / success	INTRINSIC falsity reveals itself in failure	the EXACT MIRROR- IMAGE of Mīmāṃsā

(Sāṃkhya and Buddhist placements follow standard survey presentation.)

THE DECISIVE COUNTER TO THE BUDDHIST PLACEMENT

if falsity were INTRINSIC, illusion should reveal itself AS illusion immediately
but illusion DECEIVES precisely because it does not
=> the asymmetry is rejected

WHERE MĪMĀṢĀ AGREES AND WHERE IT STOPS

with SĀṂKHYA: yes to the intrinsic side of VALIDITY
against SĀṂKHYA: no to intrinsic INVALIDITY – falsity is discovered through later defeat
against NYĀYA: no to extrinsic validity – success confirms, never creates
against BUDDHISM: no to pragmatic validity and to self-intimating falsity

MEMORISE AS A FOUR-ROW STRIP

MĪMĀṢĀ I / E NYĀYA E / E SĀṂKHYA I / I BUDDHIST E / I

ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE
Every classical Indian theory of validity occupies one cell of a two-by-two grid;
Mīmāṃsā's originality is that it is the only school that makes truth free and
falsehood expensive.

! TRAP: Sāṃkhya and Buddhism sit adjacent in every table and are routinely EXCHANGED
under time pressure. Sāṃkhya = intrinsic/intrinsic. Buddhist = extrinsic/intrinsic.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/24: The instrument list and the admission rule

	pratyakṣa perception	anumāna inference	upamāna compar.	śabda testim.	arthāpatti postulation	anupalabdhi non-cognition	
SĀṂKHYA	X	X		X			= 3
NYĀYA	X	X	X	X			= 4
PRABHĀKARA	X	X	X	X	X		= 5
BHĀṬṬA	X	X	X	X	X	X	= 6

+---- THE TWO SEATS BY WHICH ----+
MĪMĀṂSĀ EXCEEDS NYĀYA

THE ADMISSION RULE (shared by both sub-schools)

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| Admit a new instrument ONLY where a type of knowledge cannot be reduced to another |
| WITHOUT REMAINDER or WITHOUT CIRCULARITY. |
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ONE-LINE DEFINITIONS (learn verbatim)

pratyakṣa immediate knowledge produced by sense-object contact
 anumāna mediate knowledge from a sign through known concomitance
 upamāna fresh knowledge that a previously known but ABSENT object is similar
 to a presently perceived object
 śabda valid verbal testimony, especially Vedic testimony regarding dharma
 arthāpatti necessary postulation of an unseen fact to reconcile incompatible facts
 anupalabdhi ... knowledge of absence through non-apprehension of what WOULD be
 apprehended if present

THE EIGHT-STEP JUSTIFICATION

- 1 perception handles directly given objects
- 2 inference handles sign-based mediated knowledge
- 3 testimony handles verbally transmitted content
- 4 comparison handles resemblance-based identification
- 5 yet some cognitions arise NEITHER through signhood NOR positive direct perception
- 6 postulation resolves contradiction-like TENSION among known facts
- 7 absence-cognition, for Bhāṭṭa, discloses what is NOT there under proper conditions
- 8 if these cannot be reduced without circularity, they deserve INDEPENDENT status

THE THREE-TERM VOCABULARY

pramāṇa (the operative MEANS) -> pramā / pramiti (the TRUE COGNITION produced)
 -> pravṛtti-sāmarthyā (successful action: CONFIRMS correspondence, never MANUFACTURES
 validity after the cognition arose)

SUMMARY FORMULA: Bhāṭṭa = six · Prabhākara = five · the difference turns on ANUPALABDHI ·
 the whole list is governed by IRREDUCIBILITY, not by inflation.

! TRAP 1: instruments are individuated by the MANNER of generation, not by topic.

! TRAP 2: Mīmāṃsā does not oppose anumāna; it opposes REDUCTIONISM ABOUT ANUMĀNA.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/24: Perception – two stages, and the realism it protects

NIRVIKALPAKA-PRATYAKṢA ----->	SAVIKALPAKA-PRATYAKṢA
(indeterminate; also ālocana-jñāna)	(determinate)
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first NON-VERBAL awareness that an object is PRESENT, before explicit classification and predication	the object grasped AS QUALIFIED by class, quality, action and name: "this is a white moving cow"

THE CONTROLLING CLAIM

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| the determinate stage INTERPRETS what was IMPLICITLY AVAILABLE in the first stage. |
| It does NOT invent an unreal predicate. |
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supports two positions elsewhere in the system:

- (a) REALISM against the Buddhist claim that perception gives only a unique
NON-CONCEPTUAL PARTICULAR
- (b) REALISM against any view on which classification NECESSARILY FALSIFIES the given
- (c) and it underwrites Panel 21's defence of REAL UNIVERSALS against apoha

WHAT BOTH SUB-SCHOOLS SHARE

perception is accepted · it is immediate · it is realist · it is the most basic
disclosure of sensible objects

WHERE THEY DIVIDE – INSIDE PERCEPTION ITSELF

PRABHĀKARA perception is SELF-LUMINOUS as part of tripuṭī-saṃvit: the object, the
subject and the cognition are simultaneously revealed
BHĀṬṬA the OBJECT is perceived, but the COGNITION is not self-luminous; its
occurrence is INFERRED from the object's jñātatā
=> the instrument is shared; its REFLEXIVE STRUCTURE is disputed (see Panel 18)

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| ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE |
| Mīmāṃsā allows perception two stages precisely so that classification need not |
| become falsification: what the second stage says, the first stage already held. |
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! TRAP: do not treat determinate perception as an overlay imposed on a pure given. That
reading concedes the Buddhist premise and destroys the school's semantic realism.

INFERENCE (anumāna) – ACCEPTED IN FULLY STANDARD FORM

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smoke SEEN + smoke-fire concomitance (vyāpti) KNOWN -> fire INFERRED
the school has NO general hostility to inference
its distinctive move is ONLY to deny that ALL mediate cognition is inferential
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| Mīmāṃsā opposes REDUCTIONISM ABOUT ANUMĀNA, not anumāna. |
| This is what licenses arthāpatti (Panels 12-13) and anupalabdhi (Panels 14-15). |
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COMPARISON (upamāna) – THE MOST MISREPORTED INSTRUMENT

MĪMĀṂSĀ'S ACCOUNT

- 1 one has PREVIOUSLY SEEN a cow
- 2 one now PERCEIVES a wild ox (gavaya) in the forest as similar to it
- 3 from that perceived similarity arises the NEW cognition:
"the previously seen cow is SIMILAR to this gavaya"
- 4 not PERCEPTION – the absent cow is not presently sensed
- 5 not MEMORY – its similarity to this new animal was not previously known
- 6 not INFERENCE – no universal concomitance is used

NYĀYA'S ACCOUNT (do NOT write this as the Mīmāṃsā definition)
prior TESTIMONY "a gavaya is like a cow" + later perception
=> one learns the WORD-OBJECT RELATION

? Śabara is sometimes read as allowing a WIDER ANALOGICAL FORM, such as reasoning from one's own experienced self to other selves. The later similarity-cognition account is the SAFE EXAM DEFAULT.

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| ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE |
| Mīmāṃsā keeps every instrument its rivals keep and quietly re-tunes each: inference |
| is honoured but forbidden to annex its neighbours, and comparison is redefined around |
| similarity rather than vocabulary. |
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! TRAP 1: the gavaya EXAMPLE is shared by both schools; the MECHANISM is not. A candidate who remembers only the example imports the Nyāya account without noticing.
! TRAP 2: never write "Mīmāṃsā rejects inference".

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/24: Testimony – two independent classifications

CLASSIFICATION BY SOURCE

PERSONAL (pauruseya-śabda)	depends on a COMPETENT HUMAN SPEAKER and remains vulnerable to SPEAKER-DEFECT
IMPERSONAL (apauruseya-śabda)	Vedic testimony; INTRINSICALLY VALID in the supersensible domain of duty; NO speaker, hence NO defect-locus

this split is the ENTRY POINT to Panel 22 (authorlessness)

CLASSIFICATION BY FUNCTION

FACT-STATING (siddhārtha-vākya)	states an existent fact
ACTION-ENJOINING (vidhayaka-vākya)	enjoins an action

KUMĀRILA recognises the distinction WHILE MAKING INJUNCTION CENTRAL to Vedic purpose
PRABHĀKARA more radically interprets cognition AND language through action-guidance

this split is the ENTRY POINT to Panel 23 (injunctive theory)

WHY TESTIMONY IS DIGNIFIED HERE

in ordinary matters it depends on a competent source

in matters of DUTY the decisive verbal source is the VEDA

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| It is NOT a fallback after perception fails. |
| It is the ONLY ROUTE to supersensible duty. |
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| ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE
| Mīmāṃsā promotes testimony from a convenience to the sole competent witness, and
| then removes the one thing that could discredit a witness – the witness himself.
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! TRAP 1: "impersonal" does NOT mean "divine". Divine authorship is the NYĀYA route.

! TRAP 2: the source-split and the function-split are TWO INDEPENDENT CUTS across testimony; do not merge them into one classification.

WHAT A MEANS OF VALID KNOWLEDGE MUST DO

(a) operate as the SOURCE of a cognition
(b) disclose an OBJECT
(c) do so FRESHLY – NOVELTY (anadhigatatva), i.e. not-already-ascertained

MEMORY (smṛti) TESTED AGAINST (a) (b) (c)

(a) YES it operates	(b) YES it has an object	(c) NO – IT FAILS HERE it depends on an EARLIER cognition + a latent impression (saṃskāra) and RE-PRESENTS known content
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=> MEMORY IS NOT A PRAMĀṆA (both sub-schools; Nyāya agrees)

PRABHĀKARA'S FIVE STEPS

NYĀYA'S CONCURRENCE

1 a pramāṇa must generate a NEW cognition	memory presents what was ALREADY known
2 memory depends on an earlier cognition and a latent impression	it is RE-PRESENTATION, not fresh disclosure
3 it reproduces OLD content	hence it is not a pramāṇa
4 it does not reveal a new object as presently known	=> THIS IS WHY THE 2024 PAPER PAIRS "the Prābhākaras AND the Naiyāyikas"
5 therefore it is NOT a pramāṇa	IN ONE QUESTION

WHAT THE EXCLUSION DOES *NOT* SAY

memory may be TRUE · may be USEFUL · may GUIDE ACTION successfully
but USEFULNESS IS NOT ENOUGH for the title; NOVEL VALID DISCLOSURE is required
example: seeing a temple NOW is perception; recalling yesterday's visit is memory, and the latter is not new knowledge OF THE TEMPLE

WHERE MEMORY STILL DOES REAL WORK

comparison (upamāna) uses a REMEMBERED cow
Prabhākara's error-theory (akhyāti) uses a REMEMBERED silver
Bhāṭṭa sentence-comprehension uses MEMORY OF THE ORDERED SERIES of phonemes
=> memory is a working COMPONENT of cognitive life; it is simply not an INSTRUMENT

! TRAP 1: "memory is unreliable" is the WRONG reason and concedes ground to the sceptic.
! TRAP 2: over-correcting by writing memory out of the system altogether.
! RESIDUAL: because the exclusion is DEFINITIONAL, a rival may contest the definition.
Reply: the definition tracks a real difference between DISCLOSING and RETRIEVING.

THE BARE STRUCTURE

Fact A is known
Fact B is known
A and B CANNOT stand together
 unless C is admitted
therefore C is POSTULATED
NECESSITY = explanatory reconciliation

THE CANONICAL CASE – STOUT DEVADATTA

1 Devadatta is stout (perception)
2 he does not eat by day (testimony / repeated observation)
3 stoutness is INCOMPATIBLE with total absence of nourishment
4 => the two known facts produce EXPLANATORY TENSION
5 to resolve it, he must eat at ANOTHER time
6 the natural and sufficient postulate: AT NIGHT
7 night-eating is NOT directly perceived here
8 it is NOT supplied by memory either
9 it is POSTULATED, because otherwise the known data remain INEXPLICABLE

PRESUPPOSITIONS

bodily conditions have intelligible causes · stoutness normally requires nourishment
rational cognition SEEKS COHERENCE among accepted facts

THE DISTINCTION INSIDE THE CASE

the reasoning does NOT begin from a sign like smoke; it begins from TENSION BETWEEN FACTS – and the output is not merely "he eats" but the MINIMALLY RECONCILING POSTULATE. ("Minimally" is what stops postulation licensing extravagant explanations.)

TWO FORMS

ḍṛṣṭārthāpatti (from PERCEIVED facts) – the Devadatta case above
śrutārthāpatti (from HEARD WORDS) – supplies what an utterance needs to be coherent: ellipsis, contextual completion
both are EXPLANATORY NECESSITY, not tentative hypothesis; only the source of the initiating tension differs

EXAMPLE BANK

stout Devadatta, no day-eating -> eats at night (use FIRST, always)
candidate never seen studying by day, tops the exam -> studies at another time
person never seen leaving home yet present at office daily -> leaves unobserved
! canonical example first; modern examples only to illustrate

OBJECTION -> REPLY

! why not simply suspend judgement? -> the facts as accepted PRESS toward reconciliation; postulation is the cognition produced by that necessity
! any explanation could be relabelled postulation -> only postulations NECESSARY to resolve an ESTABLISHED incompatibility qualify

! TRAP: retelling the case with an added premise such as "whoever is fat eats" silently concedes the Nyāya reduction the answer was supposed to refute.

WHY ARTHĀPATTI IS NOT ANUMĀNA – three INDEPENDENT arguments

(1) NO INDEPENDENTLY ESTABLISHED CONCOMITANCE

inference requires vyāpti KNOWN BEFOREHAND, relating hetu to sādhya
we possess NO prior universal rule "all stout non-day-eaters eat at night"
the cognition arises because the facts would OTHERWISE CONFLICT
=> the engine is NOT vyāpti

(2) THE DIRECTION OF REASONING DIFFERS

INFERENCE : observed SIGN -----> unobserved SIGNIFIED
"this sign INDICATES that fact"
POSTULATION : explanatory TENSION -----> reconciling POSTULATE
"WITHOUT that postulate, THESE facts are inexplicable"

(3) NO SUBJECT / REASON / PROBANDUM STRUCTURE

standard inference parses into pakṣa (subject) · hetu (reason) · sādhya (probandum)
postulation lacks that form entirely: no identified hetu sitting in a pakṣa
what there IS: a CLASH of accepted facts and a DEMANDED supplementation

THE NYĀYA REDUCTION AND THE CIRCULARITY REPLY

NYĀYA : hetu = fatness · sādhya = eating · vyāpti = "whoever is fat eats"
MĪMĀṂSĀ : that vyāpti is NOT INDEPENDENTLY KNOWN.
If you claim it IS known, it was learned FROM LIVED CASES by exactly the
tension-driven move under dispute.

THE REDUCTION USES AS ITS PREMISE WHAT POSTULATION ALONE SUPPLIES. IT IS THEREFORE CIRCULAR.

THE 2024 APPLIED CASE – worked in the Bhāṭṭa manner

1 the candidate TOPS the examination
2 the candidate is NEVER SEEN studying by day
3 examination success is incompatible with NO preparation at all
4 therefore some UNOBSERVED preparation must be posited
5 natural postulate: study at night or otherwise outside observed daytime
NYĀYA FRAMING: "wherever there is success there is preparation; this candidate has
success; therefore he had preparation" – misses the explanatory TENSION and slides in
a vyāpti far too quickly

POSTULATION AND MODERN EXPLANATORY REASONING

it RESEMBLES inference to the best explanation, but the classical claim is STRONGER:
not "best among options" but "the postulate WITHOUT WHICH the known facts remain
untenable". That NECESSITY is why it earns instrument-status.

DISTINCTIONS TO WRITE OUT

arthāpatti is NOT a guess · NOT a probabilistic hunch · NOT standard anumāna
arthāpatti IS explanatory postulation compelled by unresolved incompatibility

WHERE IT REAPPEARS IN THE SYSTEM

it ESTABLISHES apūrva (Panel 23) and supplies the FORM of the authorlessness
argument (Panel 22) => postulation is load-bearing, not ornamental

! TRAP 1: giving only ONE of the three arguments.

! TRAP 2: omitting the circularity reply, which is the move that actually defeats Nyāya.

! TRAP 3: writing that Prabhākara rejects postulation. It is his FIFTH instrument.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 14/24: Non-cognition – seven steps and the fitness filter

DEFINITION: the independent means of knowing ABSENCE through NON-APPREHENSION of what WOULD be apprehended if present. Characteristic of BHĀṬṬA Mīmāṃsā.

KUMĀRILA'S SEVEN-STEP ARGUMENT

- 1 we DO know absences: "there is no pot on the table"
- 2 this cognition is DEFINITE and ACTION-GUIDING
- 3 not ordinary PERCEPTION – perception gives POSITIVE content
- 4 not INFERENCE – inference requires a POSITIVE SIGN
- 5 not memory, comparison or testimony in the typical case
- 6 therefore an INDEPENDENT source is needed
- 7 that source is ANUPALABDHI

THE FITNESS FILTER (yogyatā) – ALL FOUR must hold => yogyānupalabdhi

+-----+-----+ * the absent object must be the KIND of thing perceivable if present * the LOCUS must be suitable * the SENSE ORGAN must be functioning * LIGHT, DISTANCE and ATTENTION must be proper +-----+-----+	
PASSES -> knowledge of absence YES "no pot on this bare, lit table before me" NO "there are no atoms here"	FAILS -> mere non-noticing, no knowledge (atoms are not perceptible => filter fails) NO keys unseen on a cluttered desk in poor light after a hurried glance NO a sound unheard while attention is absorbed elsewhere

WHY BHĀṬṬA DENIES REDUCTION TO PERCEPTION

perception reveals what is POSITIVELY PRESENT: table, colour, shape, spatial spread
"absence of pot" is NOT a positive sensible datum of that kind
perceiving the EMPTY TABLE is one thing; cognising that THE POT IS ABSENT is another

WHY BHĀṬṬA DENIES REDUCTION TO INFERENCE

inference requires a positive sign and known concomitance
in absence-cognition NO independent positive sign is typically identified
if "not-seeing the pot" is offered as the sign, one must explain WHY not-seeing has
evidentiary force – and that force ALREADY presupposes the relevance of
non-apprehension under FIT conditions
=> the inferential reduction is either STRAINED or CIRCULAR

ORDINARY-LIFE VINDICATION

no chalk on the tray · no key in the drawer · no bus at the stop
philosophy must explain what everyday life constantly presupposes

+-----+-----+ ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE Kumārila's claim is not that something can be learned from failing to see, but that it can be learned only when failing to see is GUARANTEED to be informative – and the doctrine is the specification of when that guarantee holds. +-----+-----+	
---	--

! TRAP 1: attributing anupalabdhi to Mīmāṃsā generally. It is BHĀṬṬA's.

! TRAP 2: describing it as "not noticing". It is a DETERMINATE VERDICT of absence.

THE ONTOLOGICAL STATUS OF ABHĀVA (the 2021 core)

+-----+		
	BHĀṬṬA: abhāva is REAL. It is NOT merely a feature of language.	
	It has a COUNTERPOSITIVE (pratiyogin) – the entity whose absence is involved.	
	"absence of pot" is therefore a STRUCTURED ONTOLOGICAL CONTENT.	
	=> negative cognition has a REAL OBJECT.	
+-----+		

THE THREE-WAY DISPUTE

+-----+		
SCHOOL	WHAT IS KNOWN	IS A SEPARATE INSTRUMENT NEEDED?
+-----+		
BHĀṬṬA	a REAL absence, structured by its counterpositive	YES – anupalabdhi
+-----+		
PRABHĀKARA	the LOCUS as UNQUALIFIED by the absent object; we perceive the table as BARE	NO – the bare-locus cognition ALREADY carries the negative differentiation needed
+-----+		
NYĀYA	ABSENCE ITSELF, DIRECTLY PERCEIVED; abhāva is accepted as a real category	NO – "pot-absence-on-the-floor" is itself a perceptual object
+-----+		

=> NYĀYA AND PRABHĀKARA CONVERGE AGAINST BHĀṬṬA ON INDEPENDENCE, for DIFFERENT reasons
! do NOT therefore say "Nyāya denies abhāva". Nyāya denies the separate INSTRUMENT.

THE INTRA-MĪMĀMSĀ DEBATE (the 2025 core)

BHĀṬṬA : abhāva is real AND known by an independent instrument
 PRABHĀKARA : what is known is simply the locus as unqualified; no instrument needed
 ! answer the 2025 question as an INTERNAL dispute, not as Mīmāṃsā versus Nyāya
 KUMĀRILA'S COUNTER: economy purchased by flattening a determinate NEGATIVE judgement
 into a POSITIVE perception is FALSE ECONOMY

OBJECTION -> REPLY

! if absence is real, reality becomes overcrowded with negatives
 -> Bhāṭṭa ACCEPTS this ontological cost to preserve the reality of negative cognition
 ! non-perception is too subjective
 -> only YOGYĀNUPALABDHI under fit conditions counts, never careless overlooking

GRADED VERDICT

Kumārila preserves the PHENOMENOLOGY of negative cognition most faithfully while
 carrying the HEAVIEST ONTOLOGY – a cost he expressly accepts.
 Prabhākara is the more ECONOMICAL metaphysician; Nyāya is the most PERCEPTUALLY direct.

! TRAP: in a question about ONTOLOGICAL STATUS, forgetting the pratiyogin.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 16/24: Error – the four theories, stated precisely

THE SHARED DATUM: a shell (nacre) lies before the subject, who says "this is silver" and reaches for it.

THEORY	SCHOOL	HOW SHELL-SILVER IS EXPLAINED	THE "SILVER" IS
akhyāti / vivekākhyāti (non-apprehension of DIFFERENCE)	PRABHĀKARA	TWO VALID cognitions whose DIFFERENCE is not apprehended: perception of "this shining thing" + memory of silver	NO false silver at all
viparīta-khyāti (contrary apprehension)	BHĀṬṬA	the shell is POSITIVELY MISCOGNISED AS silver; ONE erroneous cognition	a really WRONG IDENTIFICATION
anyathā-khyāti (otherwise- apprehension)	NYĀYA	REAL silver known ELSEWHERE is presented HERE, wrongly	real, but DISPLACED
anirvacanīya-khyāti (indescribable- apprehension)	ADVAITA	an INDESCRIBABLE appearance is projected and later sublated	NEITHER real NOR unreal

+--- these two BOTH admit a false cognition and are CONSTANTLY CONFLATED ---+
 BHĀṬṬA: the object HERE is MISIDENTIFIED
 NYĀYA : an object KNOWN ELSEWHERE is MISPLACED
 => "wrong identification" is NOT "right object, wrong location"

PRABHĀKARA'S FIVE STEPS	BHĀṬṬA'S SEVEN STEPS
1 valid perception of "this shining object here"	1 the shell is before the subject
2 that perception is of the shell's present appearance	2 bad light, distance, similar shine or sensory defect causes miscognition
3 valid MEMORY of silver	3 a SINGLE erroneous cognition arises: "this is silver"
4 failure to DISTINGUISH the two	4 the cognition is FALSE
5 behaviour follows; NO separate false cognition need be posited	5 its falsity is due to EXTRINSIC DEFECT, not to cognition's intrinsic nature
	6 correction on approaching and seeing clearly
	7 invalidity is then known EXTRINSICALLY

MĪMĀṂSĀ VERSUS THE OTHER TWO

Mīmāṃsā stays more EPISTEMOLOGICALLY ANCHORED and REALIST: it neither disperses the
object elsewhere like Nyāya nor renders it metaphysically indeterminate like Advaita.

! TRAP 1: translating akhyāti as "TOTAL non-apprehension". It is non-apprehension OF
DIFFERENCE – which is why vivekākhyāti is the more precise label.

! TRAP 2: merging viparīta-khyāti with anyathā-khyāti.

THE 2022 PUZZLE, STATED

"IN SPITE OF accepting the intrinsic validity of knowledge, why and how do Prabhākara and Kumārila differ in their interpretation of erroneous cognition?"

=> the "in spite of" clause IS the question.

WHY ERROR IS THE SYSTEM'S STRESS-TEST

any theory of intrinsic validity MUST explain illusion

if cognition is prima facie valid, what exactly GOES WRONG in false experience?

=> the theories of error are not an appendix to the epistemology; they are its proof

THE TWO DEFENCE STRATEGIES

PRABHĀKARA PROTECTS *** EVERY CONSTITUENT COGNITION ***	BHĀṬṬA PROTECTS *** THE PRINCIPLE GOVERNING NORMAL COGNITION ***
the presentational cognition of "this" is valid the memory of silver is valid error lies ONLY in their conflation => NO individual cognition is ever labelled false	falsity IS admitted, but it is QUARANTINED in DEFECT-RIDDEN conditions validity belongs to cognition under NORMAL conditions; falsity belongs to defect => invalidity is known EXTRINSICALLY, through later defeat

THE COSTS ARE EXACTLY COMPLEMENTARY

PRABHĀKARA must explain the ASSERTIVE FORCE of "this is silver" by a mere failure of discrimination

! objection: this UNDERESTIMATES the assertive force of illusion

-> reply: non-discrimination can explain assertive behaviour without adding a false cognition

BHĀṬṬA must admit a FALSE COGNITION into a system built on default truth

! objection: this GRANTS TOO MUCH to falsity

-> reply: it grants falsehood ONLY under abnormal conditions, preserving the default truth of cognition

THE BEHAVIOURAL FACT THAT DIVIDES THEM

reaching for the silver must be explained

BHĀṬṬA: best explained by a POSITIVE FALSE JUDGEMENT

PRABHĀKARA: NON-DISCRIMINATION suffices

=> the debate concerns PHILOSOPHICAL PSYCHOLOGY as much as epistemology

SHARED PRESUPPOSITIONS

error must be explainable WITHOUT collapsing trust in cognition

memory and perception CAN interact

defect and correction are intelligible features of cognitive life

ANSWER-GRABBING SPINE Prabhākara saves intrinsic validity by refusing to admit a false cognition anywhere, and Kumārila saves it by admitting one and then quarantining it. The disagreement is about what price is worth paying to keep the same trust intact.
--

! TRAP: concluding that Bhāṭṭa ABANDONS intrinsic validity because he admits falsity.

THE PROBLEM

if a cognition is NOT manifest in itself, another cognition must reveal it
 ... and THAT one needs a third ... and so on => INFINITE REGRESS (anavasthā)
 ALL THREE CLASSICAL ANSWERS ARE DEVICES FOR STOPPING THIS REGRESS.

```
+--- PRABHĀKARA -----+
| ONE ACT, THREE DISCLOSURES      jñātṛ (knower) --+
| cognition is SELF-LUMINOUS      jñeya (known)  --- revealed TOGETHER, at once
| (svaprakāśa)                   jñāna (knowing)---+
| SIX STEPS: 1 cognition illuminates its object · 2 if it were not itself manifest,
| another cognition would be needed · 3 that needs a third => regress · 4 therefore
| cognition reveals ITSELF in the act of revealing the object · 5 the subject is also
| disclosed as the one who knows · 6 hence a THREEFOLD revelation
| LAMP ANALOGY: a lamp reveals itself and other things at once => economy + no regress
| ! reflection ("I know that I know") is a LATER conceptual articulation of what was
| already manifest PRE-REFLECTIVELY
| ! objection: this confuses subject, object and cognition
|   -> reply: they are simultaneously DISCLOSED, not ontologically COLLAPSED
| => NO METACOGNITIVE GAP
+-----+
+--- BHĀṬṬA -----+
| cognition is NOT self-luminous
| FOUR STEPS: 1 an object, once cognised, stands in a NEW RELATION: it is now KNOWN
| 2 that new status is JÑĀTATĀ (knownness) · 3 observing the object's knownness, we
| INFER that a cognition has occurred · 4 therefore awareness of cognition is
| INFERENTIAL, not immediate
| PAINTER ANALOGY: it paints objects but does not paint ITSELF; its occurrence is
| established through what it LEAVES BEHIND in the object
| ! objection: jñātata is a mysterious property -> reply: the cost is accepted in order
| to avoid the stronger thesis of self-luminosity
| ! objection: self-awareness feels too immediate for inference -> reply: felt immediacy
| need not equal non-inferential STRUCTURE
| => TEMPORAL AND LOGICAL GAP: "I know" first, "I know that I know" afterwards
+-----+
+--- NYĀYA -----+
| FOUR STEPS: 1 first-order cognition reveals the object · 2 a LATER inner awareness
| takes that cognition as its OBJECT · 3 it has the form "I know the pot" / "I knew the
| pot" · 4 therefore knowing-that-I-know is NEITHER self-luminosity NOR inference from
| knownness, but SECOND-ORDER APPREHENSION = ANUVYAVASĀYA
| ! objection: second-order awareness threatens regress -> reply: Nyāya treats the
| higher-order awareness as SUFFICIENT without endless repetition
| => REFLECTIVE GAP
+-----+
```

THREE GAPS, IN THREE WORDS: NONE · INFERENTIAL · REFLECTIVE

! TRAP: swapping the mechanisms. tripuṭi-saṃvit = PRABHĀKARA · jñātata = BHĀṬṬA ·
 anuvyavasāya = NYĀYA.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 19/24: Self-luminosity and intrinsic validity – the entailment grid

TWO INDEPENDENT QUESTIONS

Q1 MANIFESTATION : is cognition / consciousness SELF-LUMINOUS?

Q2 TRUTH-ENTITLEMENT : is VALIDITY INTRINSIC?

they answer DIFFERENT questions, so NO entailment follows from the definitions alone

SCHOOL	Q1 SELF-LUMINOUS?	Q2 VALIDITY INTRINSIC?	CONSEQUENCE
NYĀYA	NO – known through a subsequent anuvyavasāya	NO – ascertained extrinsically	accepts NEITHER thesis
PRABHĀKARA MĪMĀṂSĀ	YES – one cognition manifests knower, known and knowing	YES	CONNECTS both theses
BHĀṬṬA MĪMĀṂSĀ	NO – cognition inferred from acquired jñātātā	YES	*** DECISIVE COUNTEREXAMPLE TO ENTAILMENT
ADVAITA VEDĀNTA	YES – fundamentally of CONSCIOUSNESS ITSELF, not merely of episodes	at the EMPIRICAL level, prima facie until SUBLATED	CONNECTS them within a wider NON-DUAL theory

THE ARGUMENT IN ONE LINE

Kumārila = NOT self-luminous + intrinsically valid => self-luminosity is NOT NECESSARY for intrinsic validity => and since the theses answer different questions, NEITHER ENTAILS THE OTHER a SINGLE actual case refutes a claim of NECESSITY; the survey of the other schools shows that the pairing in Prabhākara and Advaita is a SUBSTANTIVE COMMITMENT, not a definitional consequence

WHY KUMĀRILA'S COMBINATION IS STABLE

manifestation is handled by jñātātā and inference · truth-entitlement is handled by the anti-regress argument => different machinery, so the two need not move together

QUALIFICATION FOR A HIGH-MARK ANSWER

independence is NOT irrelevance: a self-luminous cognition plainly makes intrinsic validity EASIER to defend – it simply does not COMPEL it

! TRAP 1: placing Nyāya as "self-luminous but extrinsically valid". Nyāya DENIES self-luminosity. Getting this cell wrong destroys the whole grid.

! TRAP 2: treating "the Mīmāṃsakas" as ONE column. The question is decided INSIDE Mīmāṃsā.

! TRAP 3: surveying the schools and never answering the word "NECESSARILY".

THE PROBLEM: EKAVĀKYATĀ – how does a sentence made of MANY words, each apparently carrying its own meaning, yield ONE unified cognition?

Mīmāṃsā MUST solve this: Vedic obligation is grasped through SENTENCE-meaning, never through isolated word-meanings.

WHY THE PROBLEM IS NOT ARTIFICIAL

- 1 the Veda works through meaningful sentences: injunctions, prohibitions, mantras, names, explanatory passages
 - 2 an injunction cannot guide action unless its words form ONE determinate action-guiding meaning
 - 3 mere SUCCESSION does not produce unity – unrelated words can be uttered side by side
 - 4 therefore the conditions of sentencehood must be specified
- ! objection: ordinary people understand sentences instantly; why a technical theory?
- > reply: Mīmāṃsā explains the LOGICAL STRUCTURE of comprehension, not the hearer's conscious procedure

THE THREE SHARED CONDITIONS (accepted by BOTH sub-schools)

CONDITION	MEANING	FAILURE CASE	FUNCTION
ākāṅkṣā (expectancy)	words mutually REQUIRE completion	"Bring..." leaves an open expectation of WHAT	why words lean
yogyatā (semantic fitness)	meanings must be semantically COMPATIBLE	"sprinkle with fire" is unfit in ordinary usage	blocks absurdity
sannidhi / āsatti (contiguity)	words must occur in proper PROXIMITY	words separated by unrelated discourse	protects Vedic boundaries

THE CONTESTED FOURTH – AND MĪMĀṂSĀ'S REAL DIFFICULTY

TĀTPARYA (purport / intended thrust) is added by NAIYĀYIKAS

! but the Veda is APAURUSEYA – there is NO speaker whose intention could be consulted

-> Mīmāṃsā must relocate purport into TEXTUAL FORCE, CONTEXTUAL UNITY and SUBORDINATION TO VIDHI

! objection: if purport is needed for human sentences, an authorless Veda becomes unintelligible

-> reply: Vedic purport is not psychological intention but SENTENCE-FUNCTION disclosed by textual relations

=> this creates GENUINE INTERNAL PRESSURE and a strong answer says so

TEST SENTENCE FOR EVERYTHING THAT FOLLOWS

"svargakāmo yajeta" – "one desiring heaven should sacrifice"

the hearer must grasp not "heaven-desirer" + "sacrifice" but the UNIFIED INJUNCTION that the QUALIFIED AGENT ought to perform sacrifice

BHĀṬṬA – abhihitānvayavāda "connection of the ALREADY DENOTED"	PRABHĀKARA – anvitābhīdhānavāda "denotation of the CONNECTED"
step 1 each word denotes its ISOLATED meaning (padārtha) via ABHIDHĀ	there is NO such first step
step 2 meanings are CONNECTED via LAKṢAṆĀ / TĀTPARYA-ŚAKTI	words denote meanings ONLY AS CONNECTED with agent, action, object and context
PRIMARY UNIT = THE WORD sentence-meaning is DERIVATIVE	PRIMARY UNIT = THE SENTENCE word-meaning is grasped IN RELATION
STRENGTH: explains STABLE LEXICAL MEANING across contexts; meaning is COMPOSITIONAL	STRENGTH: explains LANGUAGE-LEARNING and ACTION-GUIDANCE; meaning is CONTEXTUAL
! the two stages are LOGICAL, not a slow temporal sequence in consciousness	! does NOT deny that words are repeatable; denies that their PRIMARY life is isolated

PRABHĀKARA'S EVIDENCE – THE LEARNING ARGUMENT (vyutpatti): a child observes an elder command "bring the cow" and a younger person comply, and learns the CONNECTED sense from the whole event. Dictionaries are SECONDARY ABSTRACTIONS from repeated connected uses.

FOUR CROSS-OBJECTIONS

! vs BHĀṬṬA: the isolated-word stage is never observed and requires an extra lakṣaṇā or purport-operation in every sentence -> reply: the distinction is EXPLANATORY, not INTROSPECTIVE; stable lexical meaning requires word-priority

! vs PRABHĀKARA: the same word would mean differently in every sentence -> reply: recurrent connected uses yield stable competence without context-free meanings

! vs BHĀṬṬA: language-learning begins in SENTENCES -> reply: learning-history does not settle SEMANTIC STRUCTURE

! vs PRABHĀKARA: single-word commands "Cow!" "Fire!" seem meaningful -> reply: these are ELLIPTICAL SENTENCES supplied by context

VERDICT: Bhāṭṭa secures STABLE LEXICAL MEANING; Prabhākara secures CONTEXTUAL ACTION-GUIDANCE.

=====

UNIVERSALS OR PARTICULARS? (both schools reach BOTH; the dispute is PRIORITY)

MĪMĀṂSĀ : the UNIVERSAL (jāti) is primary; the individual is reached THROUGH it as instantiated in a concrete context. ARGUMENT: repeatability of "cow" requires a STABLE SEMANTIC GROUND across changing individuals.

NYĀYA : the INDIVIDUAL (vyakti) as QUALIFIED by universal and form is primary

! a universal cannot be milked, brought or sacrificed -> reply: the universal is primary FOR MEANING; ACTION reaches the qualified individual by contextual application

! BUDDHIST APOHA: "cow" works by EXCLUDING non-cows; no real universal is needed

-> reply: pure exclusion cannot explain STABLE POSITIVE RECOGNITION and REPEATABLE APPLICATION unless a shared class-character is already available

GRAMMARIAN SPHOṬA-VĀDA (Bhartṛhari) – AND ITS REJECTION

individual sounds PERISH and cannot by themselves yield the whole meaning, so a unitary VĀKYA-SPHOṬA is posited as the real bearer of meaning

-> MĪMĀṂSĀ (BOTH sub-schools) REJECTS the extra entity: eternal PHONEMES (varṇa) and their ORDERED MANIFESTATION suffice; MEMORY of the ordered series + ākāṅkṣā + yogyatā + sannidhi already yields unity

=> preserves ECONOMY and the theory of ETERNAL WORD-UNITS without Grammarian holism (and this is what Panel 22 needs)

! TRAP: A-BHI-hita goes with BHA-tta. Never hand connected-denotation to Kumārila.

THE EIGHT-STEP ARGUMENT FOR APAURUṢEYATVA

- 1 NO AUTHOR of the Veda is REMEMBERED in the tradition
- 2 an author of so momentous a text would NORMALLY have been remembered
- 3 the word-meaning relation is NATURAL (autpattika), not instituted by a person
- 4 word-units (varṇa) possess ŚABDA-NITYATVA => utterance MANIFESTS, never PRODUCES
- 5 transmission is maintained by disciplined recitation; NO event of composition located
- 6 therefore the Veda need not be treated as a composed book with a fallible author
- 7 authorial DEFECTS explain unreliability in human testimony
- 8 therefore an AUTHORLESS Veda is free of that class of defect => SELF-VALID FOR DHARMA

THE FOUR-DEFECT ARGUMENT

AGAINST NYĀYA'S GOD-GUARANTEE

a personal author MAY ERR	first PROVE God exists
MAY DECEIVE	then PROVE God is omniscient
MAY LACK COMPLETE KNOWLEDGE	then PROVE God intends truth
=> authority would depend on PROVING	each stage needs INDEPENDENT support
competence and sincerity	=> cumbersome; authorlessness avoids it entirely

WHAT APAURUṢEYATVA DOES *NOT* CLAIM

it does NOT deny that anyone recited, taught or arranged Vedic branches
transmission and recension are NOT original authorship
KATĪHA, KAUṢĪTAKI etc. can mark SCHOOLS, TRANSMITTERS or BRANCHES, not composers
example: a teacher who recites a mantra is a TRANSMITTER, not its author

THE CIRCULARITY CHARGE, IN TWO FORMS

- ! FORM 1: the Veda is authoritative because authorless – but authorlessness seems accepted BECAUSE THE TRADITION SAYS SO
- ! FORM 2 (sharper): intrinsic validity PROVES TOO MUCH – rival scriptures would become self-valid too, unless an external criterion is smuggled in

SIX REPLIES

- R1 authorlessness rests on ORDINARY REASONING + absence of a remembered author, NOT on a Vedic quotation
- R2 the reasoning has an ARTHĀPATTI FORM: extraordinary authority + no remembered authorial event => authorless transmission is the REQUIRED postulate
- R3 intrinsic validity is NOT indefeasibility; invalidity is known through doṣa or bādhaka
- R4 rival scriptures WITH known or claimed human authors possess a LOCUS OF DEFECT; an authorless Veda lacks that locus
- R5 the Veda is authoritative ONLY FOR DHARMA, where no rival instrument operates and no defeater can arise; it does not compete with perception on colour
- R6 the DIVINE-AUTHOR alternative is WORSE: a person, even a divine person, becomes a further object needing proof

RESIDUAL FORCE – state this in a critical answer

- ! weight rests on "no remembered author" and on the NATURALNESS of word-meaning
- ! JAYANTA and UDAYANA deny naturalness: the relation is SAṆKETA (convention), grounded in Īśvara's institution, and the Veda is the testimony of an ĀPTA
- > reply: conventionalism needs an INSTITUTOR whose reliability must first be proved
- ! DHARMAKĪRTI-line Buddhists reject eternal words: how can an eternal, changeless word produce a cognition AT A PARTICULAR TIME?
- > reply: the eternal word is MANIFESTED by utterance under auditory conditions, so the timed cognition depends on MANIFESTATION and HEARER-CONDITIONS
- ! Buddhist: intrinsic validity would license sectarian texts
- > reply: intrinsic validity is DEFEASIBLE; a text with an author, contradiction or detectable defect CAN be defeated

! TRAP: writing that the Veda is "God-given" or "revealed by God". The single most damaging error available on this topic.

THREE CLASSIFICATIONS THAT MUST NOT BE CONFLATED

(i) FIVE SENTENCE-FUNCTIONS

vidhi injunction enjoins a duty or rite not otherwise known [PRIMARY]
niṣedha prohibition forbids an act; negative determination of duty
mantra mantra recalls deity, material, ritual detail in performance
nāmadheya name names a rite, substance or component
arthavāda praise / explanation praises, condemns, narrates in support of a vidhi
! mantra, name and arthavāda are NOT meaningless: their Vedic function is secured by
 EKAVĀKYATĀ with an operative injunction

(ii) THREE LOGICAL KINDS OF INJUNCTION

apūrva-vidhi (novel) · niyama-vidhi (restrictive) · parisamkhyā-vidhi (exclusionary)

(iii) SEPARATE RITUAL-COORDINATION GRID

utpatti (the act) · viniyoga (subsidiary application) · prayoga (performance-order)
· adhikāra (qualified agent)

BHĀṬṬA – THE DOUBLE FORCE, on "svargakāmo yajeta"

ŚĀBDĪ BHĀVANĀ locus = the Vedic sentence

word-force IMPELS the hearer => PRAVṚTTI (impulse to act)
amśa-traya: kim? the agent's pravṛtti (sādhya/bhāvya) · kena? the
injunctive suffix and knowledge of it (karaṇa/sādhana) · katham?
arthavāda and eulogistic supports (itikartavyatā)

ĀRTHĪ BHĀVANĀ locus = the agent's own effort and ritual performance

the ACT brings about the result => PHALA (svarga), mediated by apūrva
amśa-traya: kim? SVARGA (sādhya/bhāvya) · kena? YĀGA, sacrifice
(karaṇa/sādhana) · katham? procedure, materials, sequence and
subsidiary acts (itikartavyatā)

=> WORD-FORCE PRODUCES UNDERTAKING; ACTION-FORCE PRODUCES FRUIT

! objection: the doubling is artificial -> reply: linguistic IMPELLING and real
 PRODUCTION are not the same function

PRABHĀKARA – THE SINGLE BINDING

the sentence directly presents an act as TO-BE-DONE (karya) => OBLIGATION (niyoga)

bindingness does NOT wait upon attraction toward svarga

PRABHĀKARA = NIYOGA-VADA (duty for duty's sake) · BHĀṬṬA = BHĀVANĀ-VĀDA (fruit-mediated)

! objection: if the fruit does not motivate, why act? -> reply: the cognition of the
 act AS ENJOINED is itself action-guiding for the qualified agent

! Kant comparison ONLY with the disanalogy: niyoga is HETERONOMOUS, grounded in an
 impersonal eternal Veda, and addressed to the ritually qualified ADHIKĀRIN

HOW A SENTENCE COMMANDS WITH NO COMMANDER

imperative force is carried by the LIṆ / VIDHI verbal form itself, whose relation to
its meaning is AUTPATTIKA => obligation is IMPERSONAL and STRUCTURAL

APŪRVA – THE BRIDGE, ARGUED NOT ASSERTED

1 a ritual act is TEMPORALLY LIMITED

2 its promised fruit may be TEMPORALLY REMOTE and not visibly produced

3 if the act simply PERISHED WITHOUT REMAINDER, the Vedic connection is unintelligible

4 therefore apūrva is posited as the UNSEEN LINK

5 and this postulation is defended through ARTHĀPATTI (Panels 12-13)

=> THE FLAMES DO NOT TRAVEL TO HEAVEN; THE POTENCY PERSISTS UNTIL THE FRUIT MATURES

! objection: apūrva is unverifiable and ad hoc -> reply: it is established by
 explanatory necessity, not asserted

THE VEDĀNTA SEAM

"tat tvam asi" · MĪMĀṢĀ: Vedic purposiveness requires action-guidance

ADVAITA: knowledge is NOT an action; Brahman is an ACCOMPLISHED FACT (siddha-vastu),
so such sentences are independently valid

=> the disagreement is whether Vedic meaningfulness REQUIRES action-production

NIRĪŚVARAVĀDA – EIGHT ARGUMENTS AND THE DILEMMA

no perception · failed inference (embodied potter vs bodiless creator) · no decisive
testimony · motive problem for a beginning of creation · pre-creation problem about

souls and karma · karma + apūrva SUFFICE · evil and partiality · a God-authored Veda
LOSES apauruṣeyatva

OBJECTOR: karma is unconscious; allotment is precise; hence God as KARMAPHALADĀTṚ

+-----+

THE DILEMMA: if God distributes STRICTLY BY KARMA => karma is the real principle => GOD IS REDUNDANT. If God distributes OTHERWISE => partiality and injustice => GOD IS MORALLY PROBLEMATIC.

+-----+

QUALIFICATION: DEVATĀS ARE NOT SIMPLY DENIED. They are largely MANTRA-DENOTED
entities subordinate to the sacrifice; an offering may be addressed to Agni, but the
fruit depends on CORRECT PERFORMANCE and APŪRVA, not on Agni's discretionary favour.
Kumārila also denies that any individual SARVAJÑA is established by an instrument.
? later Mīmāṃsakas and Mīmāṃsā-influenced Vedāntic traditions sometimes SOFTEN the
anti-theistic edge.

! TRAP 1: reversing the two forces. SABDI => impulse. ARTHI => fruit.

! TRAP 2: equating bhāvanā-vāda with niyoga-vada. They are RIVALS, not synonyms.

! TRAP 3: "Mīmāṃsā rejects the gods". It rejects a CREATOR and FRUIT-DISPENSER.

THE SELF – A BOOKKEEPING NECESSITY BEFORE A METAPHYSICAL THESIS

ritual duty · merit · demerit · future fruit ALL presuppose

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AN ENDURING ĀTMAN – knower · agent · enjoyer

- * PLURALITY of eternal selves, NOT one Advaitic universal subject
- * body, senses and the internal organ MEDIATE each embodied stream
- * NOT a momentary stream: persists across cognition, action, memory, responsibility and enjoyment of the phala
- * COGNITION IS EPISODIC, not an uninterrupted essence

PRABHĀKARA: the self is revealed in the THREEFOLD structure of cognition

BHĀṬṬA : awareness of cognition runs through acquired KNOWNNESS

ARGUMENT: if the self were momentary, THE AGENT WHO SACRIFICES WOULD NOT BE THE ENJOYER OF ITS FRUIT => ritual responsibility collapses

LIBERATION – STATE IT CAUTIOUSLY

? mokṣa becomes MORE EXPLICIT IN LATER MĪMĀṢĀ than in the earliest ritual orientation
NOT Advaitic identity with Brahman; release from EMBODIED SUFFERING and from
karmically generated experience

requires STOPPING fresh merit and demerit + EXHAUSTING prior karmic forces

=> thereafter no new body, no sense-mediated cognition, no painful experience

! later Bhāṭṭa and Prabhākara accounts differ in detail; do NOT convert either into
Advaita's realisation of Brahman or into Nyāya's dependence on a creator

! objection: a heaven-focused ritualism has no real soteriology -> reply: the earliest
centre IS duty and ritual fruit, but later doctrine describes release as cessation
of pain and karmic embodiment

FIVE INTER-SCHOOL FRONTS

- vs NYĀYA intrinsic vs extrinsic validity (largest contrast) · arthāpatti independent
here, reduced there · anupalabdhi independent for Bhāṭṭa, denied there ·
Veda authorless here, God-secured there · universal primary here, qualified
particular there · anuvyavasāya there
- vs ADVAITA injunction-centred vs liberation-centred and non-dualist · realist error
theory vs indescribable status => common vocabulary, DIFFERENT HORIZON
- vs BUDDHISM resists PRAGMATIC validity · denies SELF-INTIMATING falsity (illusion does
not present itself as false) · rejects apoha · rejects momentariness
- vs SĀṂKHYA SHARES the intrinsic authority of cognition · DIFFERS by making invalidity
extrinsic and by embedding epistemology in ritual hermeneutics
- vs CĀRVĀKA Cārvāka rejects authorless authority, supersensible duty, apūrva and the
non-perceptual instruments -> reply: testimony transmits inaccessible
facts, postulation resolves conflict, non-cognition discloses absence
! BUT this establishes the INTELLIGIBILITY of non-perceptual knowledge more
readily than it PROVES any particular ritual claim

PYQ OWNERSHIP, 2018-2025 – 14 PRIMARY-OWNED PARTS, EVERY YEAR REPRESENTED

- 2018 Q8(a) 20 self-luminosity => intrinsic validity? [Panels 18-19]
- 2019 Q5(e) 10 authority of Vedic knowledge [Panels 1, 22]
- 2020 Q5(c) 10 why memory is not valid knowledge [Panel 11]
- 2021 Q6(c) 15 ontological status of abhāva [Panels 14-15]
- 2022 Q6(c) 15 refuting the reduction of arthāpatti [Panels 12-13]
- 2022 Q7(a) 20 Prabhākara vs Kumārila on error [Panels 16-17]
- 2023 Q6(b) 15 Bhāṭṭa's anupalabdhi [Panel 14]
- 2023 Q8(c) 15 universals or particulars [Panel 21]
- 2024 Q5(d) 10 word- and sentence-meaning [Panels 20-21]
- 2024 Q8(a) 20 how do I know that I know [Panel 18]
- 2024 Q8(b) 15 the candidate never seen studying [Panel 13]
- 2024 Q8(c) 15 Prābhākaras and Naiyāyikas on memory [Panel 11]
- 2025 Q5(c) 10 intrinsic vs extrinsic validation [Panels 4-6]
- 2025 Q6(c) 15 Bhāṭṭa vs Prabhākara on non-existence [Panel 15]

THE ANSWER SPINE (any mark-weight)

- 1 NAME the sub-school before stating any doctrine
- 2 DEFINE in English first, IAST immediately after

- 3 GIVE the canonical example (shell-silver · stout Devadatta · pot on the table · svargakāmo yajeta · the gavaya)
- 4 STATE the rival (Nyāya first, then Buddhist or Advaita as the question requires)
- 5 GIVE the objection AND the reply
- 6 CLOSE with a QUALIFIED verdict, never a knockout

GRADED VERDICT

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|------------|---|
| STRENGTHS | rigorous theory of testimony and interpretation · original account of default entitlement · self-consistent NON-THEISTIC normativity · expansion beyond perception-inference reductionism · rule-governed interpretation |
| WEAKNESSES | ! eternality of śabda against conventionalist and Buddhist critique
! apūrva and svarga unverifiable on perception-centred empiricism
! determinate purport without intention
! late and awkward soteriology |
| CONTESTED | ? does intrinsic validity avoid circularity or relocate it into "defect" and "defeater"?
? is the atheism considered metaphysics or exegetical necessity?
? how should the development of the mokṣa doctrine be placed? |
| 10 MARKS | strongest as a theory of intrinsic validity and Vedic testimony – stated as DEFEASIBLE DEFAULT VALIDITY, not infallibility |
| 15 MARKS | original in linking epistemology, hermeneutics and duty; weak in its contested assumptions of eternal language and unseen potency |
| 20 MARKS | a coherent IMPERSONAL foundation for duty and testimony within realist presuppositions, with language-eternity, authorlessness and ritual causality left philosophically contested by Nyāya, Buddhist and Vedāntic objections |